

Builder Basics — The Sloped Roof (Extension · Intermediate)

Topic: Variables · **Course:** Builder Basics · **Type:** Extension Activity · **Level:** Intermediate · **Time:** about 38 minutes

✂ This is a bonus challenge, not a main lesson. Try it once you are comfortable building square rings with loops and you want to make a roof that steps up to a point.

A real roof is a stack of **square rings** that shrink as they go up. In the Sloped Roof world, typing `slope` builds the whole roof — this worksheet is about the **idea**, not code.

The ring's side length is a **variable** called `roof_len`. Change its starting number and the whole roof changes shape.

1 · Predict 🧠

The variable `roof_len` starts at **7** and loses 2 each layer, so the four rings have sides of **7, 5, 3, 1**. Each layer the agent walks a square ring — 4 sides, each `roof_len` stairs long.

What shape do the rings make as they stack up? Describe it in one sentence.

About how many stairs in total across all four rings? Each ring's edge is about $4 \times$ its side length (sides 7, 5, 3, 1). Write the four numbers, then add them. Show your working.

2 · Trace the Variable

1234

Walk through the build one ring at a time. For each layer, write `roof_len` for that ring, then its value **after** it loses 2 — show the subtraction.

Layer	<code>roof_len</code> for this ring	<code>roof_len</code> after it loses 2
1		
2		
3		
4		

After the 4th ring, what is the value of `roof_len` ? Why does the roof stop here instead of building one more ring?

3 · Reason About the Variable

No code here — think it through.

The roof comes out FLAT, like a box — every ring the same size. Which part of the variable rule went wrong? Explain in one or two sentences.

Imagine the variable lost 1 each ring instead of 2. How would the roof look different — would the sides be steeper or gentler? Would there be more rings or fewer before it reached the peak? Explain why.

4 · Make It Yours

The starting value of `roof_len` decides how wide the bottom ring is. Because the variable drops by 2 each ring, a bigger starting number takes more rings to shrink all the way down to 1.

Choose a starting `roof_len` so the roof has exactly 5 rings and still shrinks neatly to a peak of 1. What starting value works? List the 5 ring sizes in order, from the widest bottom ring up to the peak.

One sentence: how did you pick that starting value?

slope

one video

1 · Your code. Scroll through it. Say what each part does.

2 · Your build. Point the camera. Name the parts.

Fill the blanks:

Today I built _____.

I built it using this code: _____.

In this code I used _____.

The hardest part was _____.

That part was hard because _____.

The most fun part was _____.

Something new I learned was _____.

Write your lines here, then say them in your video.

Submit 

Send this worksheet + your video to teacher on KakaoTalk.